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Affiliations

2026– Johns Hopkins University, School of Government & Policy (Washington, DC)
- ▹ *Full Professor with tenure, and founding faculty member*
- ▹ *Professor by courtesy in the Dept. of Economics*

2023– Peterson Institute for International Economics (Washington, DC); *Non-Resident Senior Fellow*

2014– IZA–Institute of Labor Economics (LISER, Luxembourg); *Research Fellow*

2025– *Journal of Economic Perspectives* (American Economic Association); *Associate Editor*

2021– Centre for Research & Analysis of Migration (CReAM), Rockwool Fdn. (Berlin); *Research Fellow*

2023– Center for Global Development (Washington, DC); *Distinguished Non-Resident Fellow*

2025– Center for Economic Policy Research (CEPR, UK); *Invited Member*, Research & Policy Network on the Political Economy of Migration

2026– Fulcrum Project (UCSD and Dartmouth); *Mentor*

Academic Journal Articles

2026 "The effect of low-skill immigration restrictions on US firms and workers: Evidence from a randomized lottery", *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 18 (3): 43–82 (with Ethan G. Lewis). ⟨*Pre-pub. version at NBER, IZA, CReAM, CESifo, CGD, and PIIE*⟩
- ▹ Summary for VoxEU; Featured in the NBER Digest, December 2022; Referenced by White House Council of Economic Advisers in *Economic Report of the President*, March 2023
- ▹ Covered by *Wall Street Journal* [bis], NPR, NBC, CNN, *The Atlantic*, *Bloomberg Law* [bis], *Forbes*, IZA Newsroom (*Auf Deutsch*), *Macro Roundup*

2026 "Taxing High-Skill Immigration: Fundamental Problems in Evaluating Immigrant-Native Wage Gaps and the H-1B Visa Tax", *Labour Economics*, forthcoming. ⟨*Pre-pub. version at IZA and RF-Berlin*⟩

2026 "Migration or Stagnation: Aging and Economic Growth in the Republic of Korea Today, the World Tomorrow", *Asian Development Review*, 43 (3): 1–39. ⟨*Preliminary, pre-pub. versions at PIIE and CGD*⟩
- ▹ Covered by *The Economist*, *Asia Business Daily*
- ▹ Interactive: *Korea faces income losses within half a century without more labor migration*

2024 "Migration from Developing Countries: Selection, Income Elasticity, and Simpson's Paradox", *Journal of Development Economics*, 171 (October), 103359 (with Mariapia Mendola). ⟨*Pre-pub. versions at IZA, CGD, and Centro Studi Luca d'Agliano*⟩
- ▹ Research Summary for *VoxDev* at CEPR
- ▹ Covered by *The Economist*; *United Nations Dispatch*; *Bistandsaktuelt*; IZA Newsroom

2023 "Human Capital Investment under Exit Options: Evidence from a Natural Quasi-Experiment", *Journal of Development Economics*, 163: 103112 (with Satish Chand). ⟨*Pre-pub. versions at CGD and IZA*⟩
- ▹ Covered by *The Economist*, *The Atlantic* (bis), *Guardian Nigeria*

Academic Journal Articles, *continued*

2023 "Labour Mobility with Vocational Skill: Australian Demand and Pacific Supply", *Australian Ec. Rev.* 56 (4): 462–486 (with Satish Chand). ⟨Pre-pub. versions at IZA and CGD⟩

2022 "The economic and fiscal effects on the United States from reduced numbers of refugees and asylum seekers", *Oxford Review of Economic Policy*, 38 (3): 449–486. ⟨*Pre-pub. versions at IZA and CGD*⟩

▹ Covered by *Boston Globe*, *Marketwatch*, *Forbes*, *El País*, *NewsNation*, *Dziennik Gazeta*

2022 "Migration on the Rise, a Paradigm in Decline: The Last Half-Century of Global Mobility", *AEA Papers & Proceedings*, 112: 257–261. ⟨*Pre-pub. versions at IZA, CReAM, and CGD*⟩

2022 "The effect of seasonal work visas on native employment: Evidence from U.S. farm work in the Great Recession", *Review of International Economics*, 30 (5): 1348–1374. ⟨*Pre-pub. versions at IZA and CGD*⟩

▹ Covered by the *Washington Post* (bis), *Fortune*, *News & Observer*

▹ Referenced in U.S. Congress debate (video)

2022 "A Pacific Skills Visa: Improving Opportunities for Skilled Migration Throughout the Pacific Region", *Asia & the Pacific Policy Studies*, 9 (3): 430–446 (with Satish Chand and Helen Dempster). ⟨*Pre-pub. version at CGD and IZA*⟩

2021 "Violence, development, and migration waves: Evidence from Central American child migrant apprehensions", *Journal of Urban Economics*, 124 (July): 103355. ⟨*Pre-pub. versions at IZA and CGD*⟩

▹ Covered by *New Yorker*; *Washington Post* (bis); *Wall Street Journal*; *The Atlantic*; *American Prospect*; *Forbes*; *PolitiFact*

2019 "The Place Premium: Bounding the Price Equivalent of Migration Barriers", *Review of Economics and Statistics*, 101 (2): 201–213 (with Claudio Montenegro and Lant Pritchett). ⟨*Pre-pub. versions at CGD, Harvard University*⟩

▹ Covered by the *New York Times*; *The Economist* (bis); *The Atlantic*; *Axios*; *El País*; *Quartz*; *Vox*

▹ Replication code at DOI:10.7910/DVN/DHZUOT

2019 "The New Economic Case for Migration Restrictions: An Assessment", *Journal of Development Economics*, 138: 153–164 (with Lant Pritchett). ⟨*Pre-pub. versions at CGD, IZA, and Harvard University*⟩

▹ Covered by the *New York Times* and *The Economist*

▹ Replication code and data at DOI:10.7910/DVN/HFTDQZ

2019 "The Labor Market Effects of Refugee Waves: Reconciling Conflicting Results", *ILR Review*, 72 (4): 818–857 (with Jennifer Hunt). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*; *Co-released with CGD, LSE, IZA, and CEPR*⟩

▹ Summary for VoxEU

▹ Covered by *The Atlantic*, *NPR Planet Money*; *New York Times*; *Bloomberg*; *Wall Street Journal*; *The Economist* (bis); *Washington Post*; CNBC; *U.S. News*; *Miami New Times*; *Huffington Post*; Bloomberg Surveillance (1:20:15)

2018 "Immigration Restrictions as Active Labor Market Policy: Evidence from the Mexican *Bracero* Exclusion", *American Economic Review*, 108 (6): 1468–1487 (with Ethan G. Lewis and Hannah M. Postel). ⟨*Pre-pub. versions at NBER, CGD, and IZA*⟩

▹ Summary for VoxEU

▹ Covered by *New York Times* (bis); *The Economist* (bis, bis); *WSJ*; AP; *Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung*; Vox; *El Diario*; *Newsweek*; *NY Daily News*; Bloomberg; featured by *NBER Digest*

▹ Replication code and data at https://dataverse.harvard.edu/dataverse/bracero

2018 "Why don't remittances appear to affect growth?", *Economic Journal*, 128 (612): F179–F209 (with David McKenzie). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*; *Co-released with World Bank*⟩

Academic Journal Articles, *continued*

▹ Covered by *The Economist*

2018 "Deterring Emigration with Foreign Aid: An Overview of Evidence from Low-Income Countries", *Population and Development Review*, 44 (4): 667–693 (with Hannah M. Postel). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*; *Co-released with GLM-LIC and IZA*⟩

▹ Covered by *Financial Times*; *New York Times*; *The Economist*; *Washington Post*; *The Guardian*; *Mother Jones*; *CS Monitor*; *Die Welt*; *El País*; *De Standaard*; *CQ Researcher*; *Vox*

2018 "Testing for repugnance in economic transactions: Evidence from guest work in the Gulf", *Journal of Legal Studies*, 47 (S1): S5–S44. ⟨*Pre-pub. version*; *Co-released with IZA*⟩

▹ Covered by the *Washington Post*

2017 "Split Decisions: Household Finance When a Policy Discontinuity Allocates Overseas Work", *Review of Economics and Statistics*, 99 (3): 531–543 (with Erwin R. Tiongson). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

▹ Replication code and data at DOI:10.7910/DVN/2DO8QP

2017 "The Meaning of Failed Replications: A Review and Proposal", *Journal of Economic Surveys*, 31 (1): 326–342. ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

2017 "Temporary Work Visas as U.S.-Haiti Development Cooperation: A Preliminary Impact Evaluation", *IZA Journal of Labor & Development*, 6: 4 (with Hannah Postel). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

▹ Replication code and data at DOI:10.7910/DVN/J6P2KT

▹ Covered by *The Economist* (bis, ter); *Washington Post*; Reuters; NBC; CNN; UPI; *Miami Herald*; *La Opinión*

2016 "The New Role for the World Bank", *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 30 (1): 53–76 (with Michael Kremer). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

▹ Covered by *Vox*

2016 "Losing Our Minds? New research directions on skilled migration and development", *International Journal of Manpower*, 37 (7): 1227–1248. ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

▹ Covered by the *Financial Times*

2015 "Global Skill Partnerships: A proposal for technical training in a mobile world", *IZA Journal of Labor Policy*, 4:2. ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

▹ Proposal endorsed by the UN Secretary General and the UN Marrakesh Compact for Migration, Objective 18. Covered by Inter Press Service; *El País*

2015 "Skill Development and Regional Mobility: Lessons from the Australia-Pacific Technical College", *Journal of Development Studies*, 51 (11): 1502–1517 (with Colum Graham and Stephen Howes). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

2014 "A case against taxes and quotas on skilled emigration", *Journal of Globalization and Development*, 5 (1): 1–39. ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

2014 "Migration and Development Research Is Moving Far Beyond Remittances", *World Development*, 64: 121–124 (with Çağlar Özden and Hillel Rapoport). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

2013 "Why Do Programmers Earn More in Houston than Hyderabad? Evidence from Randomized Processing of U.S. Visas", *American Economic Review*, Papers & Proceedings, 103 (3): 198–202. ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

▹ Covered by *Bloomberg* and *Slate*

2013 "Blunt Instruments: Avoiding Common Pitfalls in Identifying the Causes of Economic Growth", *American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics*, 5 (2): 152–186 (with Sami Bazzi). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

Academic Journal Articles, *continued*

2012 "Counting chickens when they hatch: Timing and the effects of aid on growth", *Economic Journal*, 122 (561), 590–617 (with Steven Radelet, Rikhil Bhavnani, and Sami Bazzi). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

- ▹ *Paper awarded the Royal Economic Society Prize*

2012 "Why were Latin America's tariffs so much higher than Asia's before 1950?", *Journal of Iberian and Latin American Economic History*, 30 (1): 12–39 (with Jeffrey G. Williamson). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

2011 "Economics and Emigration: Trillion-Dollar Bills on the Sidewalk?", *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 25 (3): 83–106. ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

- ▹ Covered by the *New Yorker*; *New York Times*; *The Economist* (bis, bis); *Fortune*; *Forbes* (bis); *The Atlantic*; *Salon*; NPR, *Deseret News*
- ▹ *Subject of the American Economic Association's inaugural* Research Highlight *2015*

2011 "When Does Rigorous Impact Evaluation Make a Difference? The Case of the Millennium Villages", *Journal of Development Effectiveness*, 3 (3): 305–339 (with Gabriel Demombynes). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

- ▹ Replication code and data at DOI:10.7910/DVN/28146
- ▹ Covered by the *Financial Times*; *New York Times* (bis); *The Economist*; *Nature* (bis); *Daily Mail*

2008 "Income Per Natural: Measuring Development for People rather than Places", *Population and Development Review*, 34 (3): 395–434 (with Lant Pritchett). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

- ▹ Covered by *The Economist* and *The Atlantic*

2008 "New data on African health professionals abroad", *Human Resources for Health*, 6:1 (with Gunilla Pettersson).

- ▹ Replication code and data at DOI:10.7910/DVN/28161

2007 "The trouble with the MDGs: Confronting expectations of aid and development success", *World Development*, 35 (5): 735–751 (with Charles Kenny and Todd J. Moss). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

2007 "The ghost of 0.7%: Origins and relevance of the international aid target", *International Journal of Development Issues*, 6 (1): 3–25 (with Todd J. Moss). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

2004 "Wealth Bias in the First Global Capital Market Boom, 1870-1913", *Economic Journal*, 114 (495): 304–337 (with Jeffrey G. Williamson). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

2004 "Why Did the Tariff-Growth Correlation Change after 1950?", *Journal of Economic Growth*, 9 (1): 5–46 (with Jeffrey G. Williamson). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

1999 "Genuine Savings Rates in Developing Countries", *World Bank Economic Review*, 13 (2): 333–356 (with Kirk Hamilton). ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

1999 "Reserve Design for Species Preservation", *European Journal of Operational Research*, 112 (2): 273–283 (with Charles R. ReVelle and Justin Williams).

1993 "Homologous and illegitimate recombination in developing *Xenopus* oocytes and eggs", *Molecular and Cellular Biology*, 13 (11): 6897–6906 (with Chris W. Lehman, David K. Worthylake, Jonathan K. Trautman, and Dana Carroll).

Papers in Progress and Under Review

2026 "Taxes on International Students: Demand and Supply Response for Post-Graduation Foreign Workers on Optional Practical Training", IZA Discussion Paper 18933, IZA@LISER, Luxembourg Institute of Socio-Economic Research. ⟨*Co-released with RFBerlin*⟩

- ▹ Covered by *Nature*

Papers in Progress and Under Review, *continued*

2026 "Immigrant-Native Wage Gaps and Immigration Tariffs: Examining the Case for an H-1B Visa Tax", Discussion Paper 072/26, Center for Research and Analysis of Migration, University College London. Berlin: Institute for the Economy and the Future of Work (RFBerlin). ⟨*Co-released with IZA@LISER*⟩

2026 "Economic and Magnet Effects of Work Authorization for Asylum Seekers: Descriptive Evidence from the United States", Discussion Paper 169/26, Center for Research and Analysis of Migration, RFBerlin Institute for the Economy and the Future of Work and University College London (with Natalia Rigol and Amy M. Nice). ⟨*Co-released with Harvard Business School and IZA@LISER*⟩

2024 "Partial Legalization and Parallel Markets: The Effect of Lawful Crossing on Unlawful Crossing at the US Southwest Border", PIIE Working Paper 24-10. Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics. ⟨*Co-released with* IZA, CReAM/RFBerlin, Mason Econ., and CGD⟩

- ▹ Covered by *The New Yorker*, *LA Times*

2021 "The Fiscal Effect of Immigration: Reducing Bias in Influential Estimates", CGD Working Paper, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development. ⟨*Co-released with IZA, CReAM and CESifo*⟩

- ▹ Covered by *Wall Street Journal*, *Forbes*

2020 "Global Mobility and the Threat of Pandemics: Evidence from Three Centuries", CGD Working Paper 560, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development (with Thomas Ginn). ⟨*Co-released with IZA*⟩

- ▹ Covered by *Bloomberg*

2020 "The Emigration Life Cycle: How Development Shapes Emigration from Poor Countries", CGD Working Paper 540, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development. ⟨*Co-released with IZA*⟩

- ▹ Cited by the UK Home Secretary and covered by *The Economist*; IZA Newsroom; *The Correspondent*; *Foreign Policy*; *Washington Examiner*; *Kehitys-Utveckling*

2019 "Measuring the Spatial Misallocation of Labor: The Returns to India-Gulf Guest Work in a Natural Experiment", CGD Working Paper. ⟨*Co-released with IZA*⟩

- ▹ Covered by *India Times*; *Khaleej Times*; *Gulf News*; *The National*

Litigation Work

2026 Signatory to 'Brief of *Amici Curiae* Data and Policy Analysts', in *Kennth Genalo et al. v. Keisy G.M.* (US Supreme Court, No. 25-886)

2026 'Brief of Professor Michael Clemens as *Amicus Curiae* in Support of Plaintiffs-Appellees', in *State of California v. Mullin (26-1699)* (Court of Appeals for the First Circuit, Case: 26-1699)

2026 Lead *Amicus* for 'Brief of Economists as *Amici Curiae*', in *Markwayne Mullin, Secretary, Department of Homeland Security, et al. v. Dahlia Doe, et al.* and *Donald Trump v. Fritz Emmanuel Lesly Miot, et al.* (US Supreme Court, Case Nos. 25-1083 and 25-1084)

- ▹ Co-signed by 19 top economists, incl. three Nobel laureates (Card, Acemoğlu, Johnson)
- ▹ Covered by CNN

2025 Lead *Amicus* for 'Brief of Economists as *Amici Curiae*', in *Kristi Noem, Secretary of Homeland Security et al. vs. National TPS Alliance, et al.* (US Supreme Court, Docket No. 25A326, Case No. 25-5724)

- ▹ Also Lead *Amicus* in a follow-up brief for the US Court of Appeals, 9th Circuit (25-5724, Nov. 12, DktEntry: 43.1), considering an expanded immigration population

Litigation Work, *continued*

2025 Signatory to 'Brief of Social Science Scholars as *Amici Curiae*', in *State of Washington et al. v. Donald J. Trump et al.* (US Court of Appeals for the Ninth Circuit, 2:25-cv-00127-JCC)

2023–2024 Expert witness on behalf of the defendant in *State of Arizona et al. v. Merrick Garland et al.* (US District Court, Western District of Louisiana, 6:22-cv-01130)

▹ Case against the defendant dismissed

2020 Declaration on behalf of the plaintiff in *Human Rights First v. Chad F. Wolf et al.* (US District Court DC, 1:20-cv-03764)

▹ Rule challenged by the plaintiff enjoined by *Pangea Legal Services v. DHS* (3:20-cv-09253-JD)

Regulatory Comments

2026 "Very high cost to American innovation and economic growth if rule finalized as proposed", Comment on "Optional Practical Training Fees" (91 *Fed. Reg.* 64566), Immigration and Customs Enforcement, Dept. of Homeland Security, Docket ICEB-2026-0100, RIN 1653-AB01 (with Amy Nice and Jeremy Neufeld).

2026 "Use of the Immigration Examinations Fee Account (IEFA) for cost recovery based on George Borjas's estimates of H-1B demand", Comment on "Fee for Certain H-1B Petitions" (91 *Fed. Reg.* 54817), US Citizenship & Immigration Services, Dept. of Homeland Security, Docket USCIS-2026-0298, RIN 1615-AD20.

2026 "Economic Effects of Employment Authorization Reform for Asylum Applicants", Comment on "Notice of Proposed Rulemaking: Employment Authorization Reform for Asylum Applicants" (91 *Fed. Reg.* 8616), US Citizenship & Immigration Services, Dept. of Homeland Security, Docket USCIS-2025-0370, RIN 1615-AC97 (with Amy Nice and Natalia Rigol).

2025 "Comment challenging cost estimate provided by the Department of Homeland Security Request to Withdraw NPRM proposing a Wage Level Lottery for H-1B Selection", Comment on "Notice of Proposed Rule Making Establishing a Weighted Selection Process for Registrants and Petitioners Seeking to File Cap-Subject H-1B Petitions" (90 *Fed. Reg.* 45986), US Citizenship & Immigration Services, Dept. of Homeland Security, Docket USCIS-2025-0040, RIN 1615-AD01 (with Jeremy Neufeld and Amy Nice).

2025 "Very high cost to the nation in deterring international STEM graduate students and postdocs if rule finalized as proposed", Comment on "Establishing a Fixed Time Period of Admission and an Extension of Stay Procedure for Nonimmigrant Academic Students, Exchange Visitors, and Representatives of Foreign Information Media" (90 *Fed. Reg.* p. 42070 to 42115) posted Aug 28, 2025 by Immigration and Customs Enforcement Bureau, Dept. of Homeland Security, Docket ICEB-2025–0001, RIN 1653-AA95 (with Jeremy Neufeld and Amy Nice).

Book Chapters

2015 "Does Development Reduce Migration?", in Robert E. B. Lucas, ed., *International Handbook on Migration and Economic Development*, Northampton, Mass.: Edward Elgar Publishing, pp. 152–185. ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

▹ Covered by *The Economist*; *New York Times*; *Foreign Policy*; *Der Spiegel*; *Neue Zürcher Zeitung*

2013 "Seize the Spotlight: A Case for GCC Engagement in Research on the Effects of Labor Migration". In *Labor Mobility: An Enabler for Sustainable Development*, Abu Dhabi: Emirates Center for Strategic Studies and Research, pp. 103–120. ⟨*Pre-pub. version*⟩

Book Chapters, *continued*

2012 "The Collision of Development Goals and Impact Evaluation", in Robert Peccoud, ed., *Evaluation and its Discontents: Do We Learn from Experience in Development?*, Proceedings of the 9th AFD-EUDN Conference, Paris: Agence Française de Développement, pp. 169–197.

2012 "Income per Natural: Measuring Development for People Rather Than Places", in Oliver Bakewell, ed., *Migration and Development*, The International Library of Studies on Migration series, London: Edward Elgar Publishing, Ch. 34 (with Lant Pritchett).

2011 "The Labor Mobility Agenda for Development", in Nancy Birdsall and Francis Fukuyama, eds. *New Ideas on Development after the Financial Crisis*, Baltimore: The Johns Hopkins University Press, pp. 260–287.

2011 "The Financial Consequences of High-Skill Emigration: Lessons from African Doctors Abroad", in Sonia Plaza and Dilip Ratha, eds. *Diaspora for Development in Africa*, Washington, DC: World Bank, pp. 165–182.

2011 "Genuine Savings Rates in Developing Countries", in Karl-Gustaf Löfgren and Chuan-Zhong Li, eds. *Green National Accounting And Sustainability*, Northampton, MA: Edward Elgar, pp. 653–676 (with Kirk Hamilton).

2010 "The Biggest Idea in Development That No One Really Tried", in Emily Chamlee-Wright, ed., *The Annual Proceedings of the Wealth and Well-Being of Nations: 2009–2010, Volume II*, Beloit, WI: Beloit College Press, pp. 25–50.

2006 "Aid and Growth: The Current Debate and Some New Evidence", in Peter Isard, Leslie Lipschitz, Alexandros Mourmouras, and Boriana Yontcheva, eds., *The Macroeconomic Management of Foreign Aid: Opportunities and Pitfalls*, Washington, DC: International Monetary Fund, pp 43–60 (with Steven Radelet and Rikhil Bhavnani).

2006 "A first look at the consequences of African health professional emigration", in Treasury of Australia and Reserve Bank of Australia, *G-20 Workshop on Demographic Challenges and Migration: Sydney, 27-28 August 2005*, Canberra: Commonwealth of Australia, pp. 195–231.

2003 "Absorptive capacity: How much is too much?" and "Exit: How long should the MCA commitment last?", in Steven Radelet, *Challenging Foreign Aid: A Policymaker's Guide to the Millennium Challenge Account*, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development (with Steven Radelet).

2001 "Are we saving enough for the future?", in Jonathan M. Harris, Timothy A. Wise, Kevin P. Gallagher, and Neva R. Goodwin, eds., *A Survey of Sustainable Development: Social and Economic Dimensions*, Washington, DC: Island Press, pp. 37–41 (with Kirk Hamilton).

1997 "Are we saving enough for the future?", in World Bank, *Expanding the Measure of Wealth: Indicators of Environmentally Sustainable Development*, Environmentally Sustainable Development Studies and Monographs Series, No. 17, Washington, DC: World Bank (with Kirk Hamilton).

1997 "The Hidrovia Paraguay-Parana: A Review and Analysis of the Feasibility Studies and Environmental Assessment in the Context of Regional Development", in Environmental Defense Fund, *The Hidrovia Paraguay-Parana Navigation Project: Report of an Independent Review*, Washington, DC: Environmental Defense Fund and Fundação Centro Brasileiro de Referência e Apoio Cultural/CEBRAC (with Thayer Scudder).

Policy Writings

2026 "The Immigrants We Need Most: Graduate Students are the Key", *Milken Institute Review*, 4th quarter: 57–64, Santa Monica: The Milken Institute (with Jeremy Neufeld and Amy Nice).

Policy Writings, *continued*

2026 "A new US rule to restrict student visas will hurt the US economy", *RealTime Economics*, Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, July 27.
▹ Covered by *PBS News*

2026 "Firms allowed to hire immigrant manual laborers expand to hire more Americans", *RealTime Economics*, Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, July 2 (with Ethan G. Lewis).

2026 "What does the new Duration of Status rule mean for international students and workers?", *Brookings Commentary*, Washington, DC: Brookings Institution, July 17 (with Dan Berger, Stephen Yale-Loehr, Taylor Joseph, and Ezra Brown).

2026 "Class dismissed: The effect of international student exclusion on the US STEM workforce and economic growth", Policy Brief 26-10, Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, June 23 (with Jeremy Neufeld and Amy M. Nice).
▹ Covered by *Fortune*

2026 "The US is driving away international students at a long-term economic cost", *RealTime Economics*, Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, June 23.

2026 "Leveraging AI to Expand Skilled Labour Mobility", Washington, DC: Center for Global Development, May 11 (with Helen Dempster and Italian Labor Minister Marina Elvira Calderone).

2026 "The economic case for a $100,000 tax on H-1B visas rests on several errors", *Realtime Economics*. Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, Mar. 16. ⟨*Summarizing this research paper*⟩

2025 "From Root Causes to Shared Gains: Migration Policy for Low-Income Countries in a Labor-Scarce World", IZA Discussion Paper 18308. Commissioned by the International Monetary Fund. Bonn: IZA Institute of Labor Economics, Dec. 16. ⟨*Co-released with RFBerlin*⟩
▹ Covered by *Exame* [bis]

2025 "Brain Freeze: How International Student Exclusion Will Shape the STEM Workforce and Economic Growth in the United States", IZA Discussion Paper 18548, Commissioned by the National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine for the *Reimagining STEMM Graduate Education and Postdoctoral Career Development* Summit, Oct. 22 (with Jeremy Neufeld and Amy Nice). ⟨*Co-released by NAS*⟩
▹ Summary by IZA@LISER
▹ Covered by *The Economist*, StatNews, *Forbes*, Yahoo! News, *The Gazette*, IEEE Spectrum

2025 "New US curb on high-skill immigrant workers ignores evidence of its likely harms". PIIE Realtime Economics, Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, Sep. 22.

2025 "Skilled immigration on the chopping block? Effects of eliminating 'Optional Practical Training' in the US". PIIE Realtime Economics, Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, Apr. 8.

2024 "Modernizing the US Exchange Visitor Skills List". PIIE Policy Brief, Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, Sep. 5 (with William R. Kerr).

2024 "Expelling Excellence: Exchange Visitor restrictions on high-skill migrants in the United States", Washington, DC: Institute for Progress, Aug. 8 (with Jeremy Neufeld and Amy Nice). ⟨*Jointly released by IZA*⟩

2024 "Offering more lawful pathways for US border crossings reduces unlawful crossings", Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, Apr. 18.
▹ Covered by *Reason*

Policy Writings, *continued*

2024 "Trump's proposed mass deportations would backfire on US workers", Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, Mar. 6.

▹ Covered by *Financial Times*, *The Economist*, *US News & World Report* [*bis*], *Reason* [*bis*], *Telemundo*, *Forbes* [*bis*, *bis*], *Washington Monthly*, Mother Jones, Scripps News, Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, *FranceInfo*

2023 "Why We Won't Reach a 'Climate Migrant' Protection Category—And What We Can Do Instead", Washington, DC: Center for Global Development, Jun. 8 (with Sam Huckstep).

2023 "Climate Change and Migration: An Omnibus Overview for Policymakers and Development Practitioners", CGD Policy Paper 292, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development, May 9 (with Sam Huckstep).

▹ Covered by *The Economist*

2022 "Do Cash Transfers Deter Migration?", CGD Policy Paper 270, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development, Oct. 19. ⟨*Co-released with IZA*⟩

2022 "Doing Refugee Integration Better: Three Lessons from the Latest Research", Washington, DC: Center for Global Development, Oct. 19.

2022 "Pathways for Labor Migration from Northern Central America: Five Difficult but Necessary Proposals", *North and Central American Task Force on Migration*, World Refugee and Migration Council, Jan. 13. ⟨*Co-released with CGD and IZA*⟩

2021 "Australia needs more Pacific mid-skill migration: Here's how to facilitate it", *DevPolicy*, Oct. 15 (with Satish Chand and Helen Dempster).

2021 "Expanding Legal Migration Pathways from Nigeria to Europe: From Brain Drain to Brain Gain", World Bank-CGD report, Jul. 19 (with Samik Adhikari, Helen Dempster, and Nkechi Linda Ekeator). ⟨*Jointly released by World Bank*⟩

▹ Policy brief: "Why Europe Should Build Legal Migration Pathways with Nigeria"

▹ Covered by *Handelsblatt*, *This Day*

2021 "The Real Root Causes of America's Border Crisis: And How Biden Can Address Them", *Foreign Affairs*, Jun. 7.

2021 "Ethical Recruitment of Health Workers: Using Bilateral Cooperation to Fulfill the World Health Organization's Global Code of Practice", CGD Policy Paper 212 (with Helen Dempster), May 27.

▹ Covered by *New York Times*

2021 "The Missing Piece in Biden's Plan for Central America: Bilateral Labor Agreements", CGD blog, Feb. 9.

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2015 "Why It's Time to Drop the 'Brain Drain' Refrain", *CGD Blog*, Jun. 30.

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2007 "Smart Samaritans: Is There a Third Way in the Development Debate?", *Foreign Affairs*, 86 (5, Sept./Oct.): 132–140.

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2005 "Costs and Causes of Zimbabwe's Crisis", CGD Note, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development (with Todd J. Moss).

2005 "Aid and Growth: New evidence shows that aid flows aimed at growth have produced results", *Finance and Development*, 42 (3): 16–20 (with Steven Radelet and Rikhil Bhavnani).

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Books

2028 *The Walls of Nations*, New York: Columbia University Press, forthcoming.

1991 *Geometry for the Classroom*, New York: Springer-Verlag (with C. Herbert Clemens).

Comments and Reviews

2023 "A Landmark Study Debunks Populist Anti-Immigrant Narratives: Review of *Streets of Gold* by Abramitzky and Boustan", *The UnPopulist*, August 3.

2017 "Review of Patrick Kingsley, *The New Odyssey: The Story of the Twenty-First-Century Refugee Crisis*", *Population and Development Review*, 43 (2).

2015 "Mapping the Worm Wars: What the Public Should Take Away from the Scientific Debate about Mass Deworming", Views from the Center blog, July 30 (with Justin Sandefur).

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2009 "Thesis of a rigid revivalist: Review of *Dead Aid* by Dambisa Moyo", *Finance and Development*, 46 (3): 53–54.

2003 "Paul Streeten, *Globalisation: Threat or Opportunity?*", *Economic Development and Cultural Change*, 52 (1): 243–245.

Other Research Papers

2011 "Mobiles and mobility: The Effect of Mobile Phones on Migration in Niger", Proceedings of the German Development Economics Conference, Berlin 2011 No. 2 (with Jenny Aker and Christopher Ksoll).

2007 "Do visas kill? Health Effects of African Health Professional Emigration", CGD Working Paper 114, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development.

2004 "The long walk to school: Development goals in historical perspective", CGD Working Paper 37, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development.

2004 "Inequality, Institutions and Long-Term Growth in Colombia", Manuscript (with William Easterly and Carlos Esteban Posada).

2003 "Who Protected and Why? Tariffs the World Around 1870–1938", Harvard Institute of Economic Research Discussion Paper No. 2010, Dept. of Economics, Harvard University (with Christopher Blattman and Jeffrey G. Williamson).

2002 "World Bank Capital Neither Complements Nor Substitutes for Private Capital", CGD Working Paper 20, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development.

2002 "Do Rich Countries Invest Less in Poor Countries Than the Poor Countries Themselves?", CGD Working Paper 19, Washington, DC: Center for Global Development.

1998 "Estimating National Wealth: Methodology and Results", Environmental Economics Series, Paper Number 57, Washington, DC: World Bank (with Arundhati Kunte, Kirk Hamilton, and John Dixon).

Teaching

2027 **Getting Unstuck: How Big Reforms Happen on the Hardest Issues, from Housing to Immigration** (Undergrad.), Johns Hopkins University (with Steven Teles)

2026 **Short Course on the Economics of Immigration and Innovation** (PhD), Institute for Progress

2023–2026 **Economic Problems and Public Policies** (Undergrad.), George Mason University

Teaching, *continued*

2022	**How Migration Policy Shapes Economies, Local and Global** (Master's), Georgetown University McCourt School of Public Policy and Walsh School of Foreign Service
2003–2010	**Macroeconomics** and **Thesis Advising** (Master's), Georgetown University McCourt School of Public Policy
2005	**Foreign Aid Effectiveness** (Ph.D.), University of Copenhagen
2002	Certificate of Distinction in Teaching, Derek Bok Center for Teaching & Learning, Harvard Univ.
2001–2002	**Economic Development in East Asia** (Undergrad.), Harvard Univ. Dept. of Economics
2001	**Globalization and History** (Undergrad.), Harvard Univ. Dept. of Economics

Previous Affiliations

2023–2026	Dept. of Economics, George Mason University (Fairfax, VA); *Full Professor with tenure*
2021–2023	US Agency for International Development; *Expert Development Economist* ▹ *Office of the Administrator, TS security clearance*
2002–2023	Center for Global Development (Washington, DC) ▹ *Director for Migration, Displacement, & Humanitarian Policy, 2019–2023* ▹ *Co-Director for Migration, Displacement, & Humanitarian Policy, 2017–2019* ▹ *Research Fellow, 2002–2010; Senior Fellow, 2010–2023; Research Manager, 2011–2017*
2022	Georgetown University (SFS & McCourt School); *Adjunct Professor*
2016–2022	*Journal of Population Economics* (Springer); *Associate Editor*
2016–2020	*World Development* (Elsevier); *Associate Editor*
2011	Dept. of Economics & Wagner School, New York University; *Visiting Scholar*
2003–2010	McCourt School of Public Policy, Georgetown University; *Affiliated Associate Professor*
2000–2002	Center for International Development, Harvard University; *Research Fellow*
1998–2000	World Bank; *Consultant*, environmental economics
1999	Bain & Company (Istanbul, Turkey); *Associate Consultant*
1996 & 1997	World Bank; *Summer Assistant*, environmental economics
1994–1995	Thomas J. Watson Foundation; *Watson Fellow* in Bogotá, Colombia & Cuiabá, Brazil

Honors

2013	Royal Economic Society Prize for best paper published in the *Economic Journal* in 2012 (with co-authors Steven Radelet, Rikhil Bhavnani, and Sami Bazzi).
2010	Invited for 15th Sir Arthur Lewis Memorial Lecture, Eastern Caribbean Central Bank.
2010	Devex.com "40 young leaders shaping the way international relief and development assistance are being delivered".
1996–2000	National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship.

Peer Reviews

Referee reports for *American Economic Review*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *Review of Economic Studies*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Journal of the European Economic Association*, *Journal of Economic Literature*, *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, *American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics*, *Journal of Labor Economics*, *Journal of Human Resources*, *ILR Review*, *Labour Economics*, *Journal of Development Economics*, *Science*, *Science Advances*, *Journal of Economic Growth*, *Journal of Economic History*, *Economic Development and Cultural Change*, *Journal of International Economics*, *World Development*, *Journal of Population Economics*, *Journal of Health Economics*, *World Bank Economic Review*, *Journal of Politics*, *Scandinavian Journal of Economics*, *Economic Inquiry*, *Public Choice*, *European Economic Review*, *The Lancet*, *International Migration Review*, *Population and Development Review*, *Journal of Globalization and Development*, *Regional Science and Urban Economics*, *Journal of Economic Surveys*, *European Economic History Review*, *Journal of Development Effectiveness*, *Review of World Economics*, *Journal of Iberian and Latin American History*, *Journal of International Money and Finance*, *Economic Notes*, National Science Foundation, World Bank Research Committee, Princeton University Press, Oxford University Press, MIT Press, Stanford University Press, Zed Books, *Journal of Economics and Growth of Developing Areas*, *Health Affairs*, *Human Resources for Health*, *Financial History Review*, *Social Science & Medicine*, *Georgetown University Public Policy Review*, numerous external academic tenure reviews.

Influence

Research

Academic citation statistics at: Google Scholar | SSRN | RePEc IDEAS | ResearchGate

Invited to IOM Migration Research Leaders Syndicate, 2017

Top 0.57% of academic economists on RePEc IDEAS citations (398 out of 70,287 economists), for publications in the last ten years: Jan. 2015–Jan. 2025

Replication data and code: https://dataverse.harvard.edu/dataverse/mclem

"Six Vital Voices on the Economics of Migration", by *NewsDeeply*

Social media

"20 most influential think tank experts on Twitter, 2017" by ESGlobal.

Foreign Policy magazine "Who's who of the foreign policy Twitterverse" 2012 and 2013.

Education

2002 **Ph.D., economics**, Harvard University Dept. of Economics, Cambridge, MA
- ▹ *NSF Graduate Research Fellowship; Derek Bok certificate of distinction in teaching*
- ▹ *Fields: Economic history, development economics, public economics*

1997 **M.S., econ. & environmental management**, Johns Hopkins University, Baltimore, MD
- ▹ *Abel Wolman Merit Scholarship*

1994 **B.S., engineering and applied science**, California Institute of Technology, Pasadena, CA

Personal

Languages: English (native); Spanish (advanced)
Portuguese, French, Turkish (intermediate)

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